



Deadly gaze

From its lair in a rocky reef, a mantis shrimp watches for food using the most complex eyes in the animal world. Mounted on stalks, they follow the slightest movement, swiveling independently or fixing potential prey with their unblinking stare. Each eye has 12 different kinds of color-detecting cell—compared to just three in humans—and a highly sensitive central band that analyzes shape and depth. Using this information, the mantis shrimp takes aim and then suddenly grabs its victim with its lethally barbed front legs.